



Friends of Parkinson's Park Annual General Meeting

Wednesday 29th April; 7:30 Methodist Church, Oxford Road, Guiseley

MINUTES

IN ATTENDANCE		<u>Directors of Parkinson's Park:</u> Chris Parapia (CP) Chair Ryan Sample (RS) Finance and Funding Director Susan Wright (SW) Vice Chair and Secretary Nicola Denson (ND) Project Planning and Publicity Director Andy Cheetham (AC) Technical and Facilities Director Hazel Berry (HB) Membership Director <u>Other Attendees:</u> Karam MacDonald (KM) Bernard Hornby (BM) Cedric Beaume (CM) Ludmila Beaume (LM) Martin Smith (MS) APPOLOGIES Josie Brooks (Ecology Director)
1.0 Welcome Address		Meeting opened at 7:40pm. Chris Parapia welcomed everyone to the meeting and introduced herself as the Chair of the Directors of Parkinson's Park. She then introduced the other Directors present at the meeting Advised that Josie was unable to attend the meeting. There are other roles that are currently vacant
2.0 Progress made by FOPP to date		It has been a rollercoaster few weeks in the Park, however a lot of positive things have been achieved during the year: The Lantern Parade – led by Andy Work Parties Planting at the Hillside Entrance – led by Nicola Decoration of the Celebration Tree – led by Susan

		World Book Day Valentine's Day Easter Theme Great British Spring Clean – led by Chris Renovation of the Bog Garden – led by Chris Planting of trees – led by Chris Orchard – led by Hazel Planting of Fruit trees and bushes Pruning of the trees Fairy Doors in Top Copse – led by Nicola Josie and her husband have supported us as to what we should do to maintain the environment of the Park The support of Open Country (an organisation supporting people with learning difficulties) has been much appreciated helping to trim bushes, plant bulbs and generally assist with tasks around the Park Hazel's Scouts have also been of tremendous help in keeping the park tidy, especially clearing fallen branches and undergrowth. We have also had the help of other groups including Guiseley Parish Church, local schools and Aireborough Together The land belongs to Belway Homes and is managed on their behalf by Meadfleet, which is responsible for some aspects of the work undertaken in the Park. Over the years the relationship between FOPP and Meadfleet has been variable. Lately however things have improved. Meadfleet, along with similar organisations seem keen to work with local groups and see the benefit of working with them.
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		The land is a public space given to the people of Guiseley by the Parkinson brothers. It is privately owned and Leeds City Council have no direct involvement. The land is protected as a Natural Green Space for the future Over the years there have been issues with anti-social behaviour. These seem to occur in phases, the latest occurring recently when damage was caused to the newly planted trees in the orchard and other areas of the Park. There have also been incidents involving dogs not being under control although many people walk their dogs in the Park without incident. There is also a problem of dog “poo” bags left lying around or tossed into bushes. We would ask that people do clear up after their dogs and dispose of the bags correctly. Dates of events 2026 <table><tr><td>Guiseley Carnival</td><td>28th June at St Oswald’s School</td></tr><tr><td>FOPP Gala</td><td>06th September</td></tr><tr><td>Walk Around the Park</td><td>11th September</td></tr><tr><td>Lantern Parade</td><td>13th December</td></tr></table>	Guiseley Carnival	28 th June at St Oswald’s School	FOPP Gala	06 th September	Walk Around the Park	11 th September	Lantern Parade	13 th December
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3.0 Finances		Ryan explained that FOPP was a Community Interest Company and that the accounts are published at Companies House. The year end is 31st March We operate on a relatively small budget. The main income is from the events we run, particularly the Gala. Last year’s income was £2,800. Expenditure on maintenance was £1,600, mainly on refurbishment of the Bog Garden. This is more than usual. FOPP has £4,000 to £5,000 in the bank								
4. Presentation of the		A Power Point presentation was used by Nicola to present the Management Plan.								

Management Plan to 20300	FOPP was formed in 2011. At that time the Park was unloved and there was a lot of anti-social behaviour. Although the Park is not owned by Leeds City Council FOPP tries to follow the By-Laws and guidance issued by it. There is no playground in the Park as this has been refused by Bellway Homes, owners of the land The Park is a haven for plants and wildlife as well as providing open space for people to visit and enjoy. Nicola then showed a map of the Park, showing the location of the different areas managed by FOPP There is a wide range of visitors to the park for example people walking dogs or using it as part of their fitness routine. These visits may be short but are regular. An issue that continues to be raised is of litter and dog “poo bags”. Volunteers do regular litter picks to keep the Park tidy. Problems have been encountered of dogs not being kept under control. The Management Plan has revealed some vacancies on the Board of Directors and more members and volunteers are needed to support FOPP and the Park. We would love to run more events but need more help. None of the Directors are paid, all money raised is used to maintain and enhance the Park. FOPP works with other groups and organisations for the benefit of the Park. Local primary and secondary schools have been very receptive. Current Plans There is a MAINTENANCE WORK PLAN to show what needs to be done, for example litter picking, paths, benches, and notice boards
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		The PROJECT UPKEEP PLAN allows the Board to monitor and plan regular events, currently the Gala and Lantern Parade There are plans to introduce an accessible path that could be used by wheelchairs and pushchairs. The geography of and access to the Park will be factors to overcome. A regular newsletter would be welcomed The Management Plan is reviewed at every meeting of the Board. We can review what is coming up and what needs to be done. The plan is to be fully reviewed and, if necessary, revised every year. Going forward FOPP now has an excellent new website created by Andy Cheetham and a Facebook page to enhance our presence in the community. FOPP will also have a stall at Guiseley Carnival and plans to now hold an AGM every year. The full Management Plan is available on the FOPP Website.
5.0 Proposal for a Friends Membership Scheme		There is a very low-key membership scheme in place but it is out of date and not used FOPP would like people to give us their ideas and an idea of what they would like from any kind of scheme. The Scouts are very keen to help out and as most go to Guiseley School it is hoped that this will increase involvement of the next generation. It will be nice to speak to people at the end of the meeting to canvass opinion

6.0 Any Other Business	6.1 6.2 6.3 6.4	KM - Are donations paid into a bank account? RS confirmed this was the case KM – Are donations Gift Aided? RS the time taken to register Gift Aid and to make the claim is disproportionate to the very small return that would be achieved. If donations were higher this is something that could be looked at. We were looking into a QR code on the website to enable people to pay donations directly into the bank account CP FOPP did belong to Local Giving but their charges were put up and payment had to be made upfront which would exceed the amount FOPP would receive so we are no longer members BH – Why is FOPP not a charity? RS – this and other options have been considered and it was decided being a CIC was best. At the time FOPP became a CIC there were not many but now there are lots of them. KM – On the issue of accessible paths Tranmere Park Primary School were given telegraph poles by BT. Bark Paths would not be suitable ND – agreed any paths would need to be more substantial and FOPP has considered whether local businesses would help. However at the time this was first discussed Meadfleet were not keen – it was concerned about the upkeep of such a path. Now there is a new management team who are obliged to show it is supporting the local community so FOPP hopes it will be more receptive to the idea. CP – Builders now need to be more accountable but residents will need to pay SW – Asked if Bellway provide detailed accounts to the residents of the estate KM – confirmed detailed accounts were provided for the estate but not for the park BH – there are 204 houses on the estate and each pays £200 a year
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6.5	CP - £3,000 of the amount paid by the residents is allocated to the upkeep of the Park. This money is not paid to FOPP but is used directly by Meadfleet to pay for any work they undertake. It does pay the insurance premium for the Park each year.
6.6	CB – Is it teenagers that are responsible for the anti-social behaviour in the Park? CP – we don’t know who is responsible. Witnesses don’t like to come forward and be identified, especially if they live on the estate. People are nervous about making complaints HB – last summer there was a lot of really loud noise in the Park, some of which sounded very rough. She reported this to the Police who confirmed no one else has reported this. Local Councillor Eleanor Thompson has said that people should report every incident of anti-social behaviour to the Police as the more that is reported the more likely they will become involved. The issue of anti-social behaviour is on her manifesto for the local elections CP – it is possible to report such incidents on the West Yorkshire Police website. It is an easy procedure to use with a list of behaviours to report. She has used it and the Police have responded very quickly. It saves time being on hold on the 101 number. If the Park is kept nice it is hoped this will deter ASB KM – confirmed the land at the side of her property was used as a dog walk and for fly tipping. This has been reduced since she started to maintain the land CP – the Community Support Officers do patrol the Park. They are based in Otley. Anything reported to the Police does get a crime number. This is needed if a claim on the insurance is to be made. Anti-social behaviour seems to come in waves. There may be no incidents for a long time and then crops up. Most of the perpetrators seem to come from the estate.

		We want to encourage young people to use the Park responsibly. FOPP does not keep a formal log of ASB but this might be a useful thing to do to see if there was a pattern to the behaviour KM – confirmed there is no residents association. There is no Neighbourhood Watch There used to be Park Watch - ? bring this back
	6.7	Litter Litter bins cannot be installed in the Park or at the entrances as Leeds City Council will not empty them. There are bins adjacent to or not far from some of the entrances. CP – FOPP did buy some litter pickers along with Guiseley School and has recently given some more to her. KM asked if she could have one which Chris will supply to her
	6.8	Eddisons Fields Estate HB - FOPP has tried to involve the estate residents. 200 leaflets were distributed to the houses advising of the AGM and it is disappointing that more residents have not attended. Should FOPP do more to engage with the residents KM – will try to find out more as to whether there is a Facebook page
	6.9	CB – Posters do not make it clear the AGM was for FOPP and not the Methodist Church SW – Noted this. Has highlighted the posters put up on the crossing by Morrisons and near Tranmere Park School. Will make it clearer next year.
	6.10	Other points and comments
	6.10.1	Problems in other areas have been resolved by more involvement with local schools

	6.10.2 6.10.3	HB – there is an Eco Committee at Guisley and Menston Schools. She will contact them to see if they can be more involved SW – Guiseley Primary School used to help make decorations for the Celebration Tree but have not done so recently. She will contact them again Can local garden centres contribute more? They have been approached in the past but have not been keen. Could look at this again CP – Meadfleet contacted her yesterday to advise they have an initiative to plant bluebells in the Park. SW – this is good as she has now taken responsibility for the Bluebell Wood. However some clearance of bramble is necessary and this should not be done until later in the year CP – Could we involve the schools in planting the bluebells – not all children want to go to university and ideal opportunity for them to be involved in this project SW – will look at best time to plant the bluebells
7.0 Close of Meeting		Chris Parapia thanked everyone for attending the meeting Meeting closed at 8.45pm